SCORPIO COMES OF AGE



MAHINDRA HAS TAKEN THE VERY BASICS OF THE 20-YEAR-OLD SCORPIO TO CREATE THE SCORPIO-N AND TAKE ITS LEGACY INTO AN AGE OF ELECTRONICS AND CONNECTIVITY

BY YOGENDRA PRATAP

The Scorpio is one of the biggest success stories of the Indian automotive industry, and provides a practical and affordable means of transport to lakhs of families with over eight lakh vehicles sold since its launch in 2002. From then till now, a lot has changed on the Scorpio. What has remained the same are the body-on-frame construction, the longitudinal engine layout with primary-driven wheels being at the rear, the seating for up to seven passengers, the sideways-opening back door and the boxy shape.

The Scorpio-N is in essence an all-new car. On the outside, with its pleasing proportions is a muscular stance, dual rectangular LED headlamps upfront and an iteration of another iconic tail-lamp signature at the rear. There are many small elements that point to a contemporary design including the trendy 17- and 18-inch alloys, the chrome both above and below the bonnet—a strip that connects the headlamps in the front on top of the grille and the skid-plate below.

On the inside as well, the two Scorpios are as different as chalk and cheese. There are a lot of elements that we first saw on the XUV700, including the infotainment system powered by AdrenoX but the Scorpio, like the outside, has its own distinct identity, and one that has been taken quite a few notches higher with the N. There are also other carry-forwards like the sound by Sony, and Alexa built-in features that first debuted on the XUV700. The 8-inch infotainment system screen and the 7-inch multi-information display in the instrument panel take centre-stage while the dual-tone dash with premium-looking materials also holds the eye. From the steering to the switchgear, everything seems to scream class, and steps forward to justify the price tag.

Engines: 2.0-L, turbo-petrol
2.2-L, turbo-diesel
Power: 203 bhp @5,000 rpm
175 bhp@3,500 rpm
Gear box: 6-speed MT/ AT
Price: Rs 18.99-21.45 lakh (ex-showroom)

With increased width, length and wheelbase, there is much more in-cabin space than ever before and than in a large gamut of SUVs that come in its price range. The last two seats now form the third row that faces the front but for grownups, they're only good for short journeys. Even though the boot space is deep and easily accessible given the side-hinged door at the rear, the third row has to be folded for any meaningful baggage space. For the top-of-the-line cars that we are driving, the feature list is never-ending, plus there are over 70 connected features as well, along with six airbags, electronic stability control and front and rear cameras. Of course, there is no dearth of convenience features like multiple USB chargers and the one-touch